

AI Decoded for Salter Brothers Leaders

Every hyperscaler, consulting firm and SaaS vendor will come with their version of the AI story. This sheet gives you the vocabulary to evaluate them on your terms, not theirs. **The goal is not to become a technologist. It is to become an intelligent buyer and a decisive leader.**

THE FUNDAMENTALS

Artificial Intelligence^{AI}

An umbrella term for computers doing tasks that once required human thinking: understanding language, recognising patterns, making decisions. Covers everything from energy optimisation to generative chat.

Analytical AI

Finds patterns in your own historical data to predict outcomes. Revenue forecasting, demand modelling, energy scheduling. You already use elements of this.

Works on your data. Knows nothing about the outside world.

Generative AI^{GENAI}

AI that creates new content by reasoning across vast human knowledge. ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini are all generative AI. Old search showed results. Generative AI has a conversation.

Large Language Model^{LLM}

The engine behind ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini. Trained on enormous volumes of text to understand and generate human language. Each company builds its own model.

The technology your future guests are already using to plan travel.

AGENTS AND AUTOMATION

Agentic AI

AI that takes action without waiting to be asked. It monitors, decides and acts across systems on your behalf. The difference between a concierge who recommends a restaurant and one who recommends, books the table and arranges the car.

The invisible chief of staff operating across your portfolio, 24 hours a day.

AI Agent

A specific AI system built to accomplish a defined set of tasks autonomously. A Guest Intelligence Agent, a Revenue Agent, an Event Agent can all operate simultaneously from a single data layer.

Digital Twin

A real-time virtual model of your property that mirrors actual operations. Allows you to simulate decisions before committing: "What happens to spa yield if we move check-in to 1pm?"

Simulate before you act. The general manager's most powerful tool.

Agent Sprawl

What happens when AI agents are deployed without governance. Costs spiral, complexity grows, value is unclear. Frontier firms are already designing against this from day one.

DISCOVERY AND DISTRIBUTION

Generative Engine Optimisation^{GEO}

The new SEO. Making sure AI engines can find your property, understand it accurately and recommend it confidently. SEO was for Google. GEO is for ChatGPT, Claude and Perplexity.

Without GEO: AI either does not recommend you or describes you incorrectly.

Zero-Click Search

When a guest gets their answer from AI without visiting any website. 69% of searches are now zero-click. The guest journey increasingly starts and ends inside an AI conversation.

Your future guest may never visit Worlds Apart. They may book from within an AI conversation.

Model Context Protocol^{MCP}

The open technical standard that lets AI engines connect directly to your live hotel data rather than guessing from outdated web scrapes. The USB-C connector for AI. Without it, AI often routes guests to OTAs instead.

AI-Native Distribution

Hotels appearing directly inside AI conversations with live rates, brand-approved content and commission-free booking links. Booking.com and Expedia were ChatGPT launch partners on day one. They are capturing AI bookings right now.

In the last era, brands fought for page one on Google. In the next, they fight to be the answer inside AI.

DATA ARCHITECTURE

Data Intelligence Layer

A unified, governed layer connecting all property data into a single trusted source that AI agents, workflows and guest experiences draw from. Not a technology product. A strategic architecture decision.

This is your moat. Models will commoditise. Your proprietary guest intelligence will not.

API-First and Headless^{API}

Technology built from the ground up to share data openly with other systems. Every PMS, SaaS platform or app you choose must pass this test. Vendor lock-in breaks the data flywheel.

IoT and Edge Computing^{IoT}

The network of sensors and connected devices throughout your property feeding real-time operational data: HVAC, energy, occupancy, maintenance signals. Your property is already generating intelligence. Most of it is going unread.

Token and Cost Governance

Tokens are the unit of text an LLM processes. Every AI interaction has a cost. Without design discipline, costs spiral. Purpose-built smaller models for specific workflows cost far less than calling large general models for every task.

GEO VERSUS SEO · THE CRITICAL DIFFERENCE FOR WORLDS APART

	SEO · THE PREVIOUS ERA	GEO · THE ERA WE ARE IN NOW
PLATFORM	Google	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity
GOAL	Rank high in results	Be cited in the answer

CONTENT FOR	Links and landing pages	Structured, machine-readable, answer-ready
WHAT YOU MEASURE	Click-through rate	Citation frequency, share of model
RISK OF FAILURE	Low ranking, fewer visitors	Complete invisibility, not mentioned at all
OTA RISK	OTAs outspend you on keywords	OTAs already inside AI as launch partners, capturing bookings now

QUICK DECODER WHEN YOU HEAR IT IN A VENDOR CONVERSATION

Agentic AI AI completing tasks from start to finish without being prompted
MCP Technical standard connecting AI engines to live hotel data
GEO Making your property discoverable and accurate inside AI answers
LLM The engine powering ChatGPT, Claude and Gemini
API-First Systems that share data openly; the non-negotiable technology test
Data Intelligence Layer The unified data foundation that makes every AI investment coherent
Digital Twin Real-time property simulation for smarter operational decisions
Token Optimisation Designing AI to manage costs, not just capabilities
Agent Sprawl Ungoverned AI agents creating cost and complexity without value

FOUR ACTIONS TO TAKE THIS WEEK

Start where you are. These actions require no budget, no technology decisions and no approval. They require only attention and honest observation.

01 Identify an Organisational Decision for Analytical AI Find one very specific organisational decision or process in your area that could benefit from analytical AI tools. Think: forecasting, scheduling, reporting, energy, yield. Where does data already exist but insight is slow or manual?
02 Identify a Process for Generative AI Find one process or workflow in your area where generative AI could drive greater efficiency or enhance the guest experience. Think: communications, proposals, briefing documents, content, guest messaging, event planning responses.
03 Audit Your Repetitive Tasks for Automation Take stock of the repetitive tasks in your week. Identify your top three candidates for AI automation. For each one, note the nature of the task, the pain level it causes and the AI potential to automate it. Bring this to the next leadership session.

+ PRIORITY ACTION START AT THIS OFFSITE Use AI as your strategic thought partner this week. Open Claude or ChatGPT, set the context of your role and your properties, and begin exploring one challenge you are currently working on. Ask it to help you think, not to give you the answer. Notice what emerges. <i>This is a capability you are building, not a tool you are testing.</i>
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"Human loved. Machine readable. The AI stands behind the brand. Trust is the product."

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LEADERSHIP OFFSITE MAY 2026
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